

Text Elements

Learning Objectives

- Use heading, paragraph, and formatting tags to structure text content
- Apply semantic HTML tags to convey meaning and improve accessibility
- Create well-organized content using lists and block-level elements

Engage (5-7 minutes)

A newspaper article has headlines, subheadings, body text, and lists. HTML text elements replicate this structure digitally, making content readable for both humans and search engines.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Create an HTML page with three levels of headings, multiple paragraphs, bold and italic text, a blockquote, and an ordered list. Apply semantic tags like `strong`, `em`, and `cite`. Compare how the page looks versus how screen readers interpret it.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Headings `h1` through `h6` create a content hierarchy. Paragraphs `p` define text blocks. `strong` and `em` emphasize text semantically (not just visually). Blockquote marks quoted content. Ordered lists use `li` items numbered automatically; unordered lists `ul` use bullet points. Semantic tags improve SEO and accessibility.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Convert a plain-text article about climate change into structured HTML with proper headings for sections, bold for key terms, italic for scientific names, a blockquote for an expert opinion, and a numbered list of causes. Ensure the hierarchy is logical from `h1` to `h3`.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Review a peer's HTML page. Check for proper heading hierarchy (no skipping levels), correct use of semantic tags versus presentational tags, and well-formed list structures. Provide two suggestions for improvement.